

Jonathan Zheng

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EDUCATION

Denison University, Granville, OH Expected Graduation: May 2029
Bachelor of Science, Applied Mathematics | Bachelor of Arts, Piano Performance
Minor, Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence

Beijing No.35 High School, International Division, Beijing, China May 2025
High School Diploma, International Curriculum
GPA: 3.96

HONORS & AWARDS

The Fannie Judson Farrar Memorial Music Prize, Denison Music Department May 2026

The Gayle Ingraham Smith Award, Denison Music Department May 2026

RESEARCH

Lisska Center Summer Scholar, The Lisska Center for Intellectual Engagement May 2026 – Aug 2026
Subject: Technique, Structure, and Expression in Prokofiev's Piano Concerto No.2
PI: Dr. Sun Min Kim, Denison Music Department
Main tasks:

- Executed 6-8 hours of daily intensive practice over ten weeks to master all four movements of Prokofiev's Piano Concerto No. 2, utilizing pedagogical frameworks (e.g., the Taubman Approach) to overcome complex technical challenges and build physical endurance.
- Conducted comprehensive score analysis and comparative listening research of multiple recordings to evaluate diverse interpretive approaches, pacing, and harmonic tension.
- Synthesized historical and pedagogical literature, including works by Maurice Hinson and György Sándor, to inform the structural understanding and technical execution of twentieth-century piano repertoire.
- Collaborated with a faculty mentor through bi-weekly meetings to refine musical interpretation, culminating in the full memorization and performance-ready preparation of the concerto for competitive and recital settings.

EXPERIENCE

Michal D. Eisner Center for the Performing Arts, Granville, Ohio Sep 2025 - Present
Tech Performance Crew

- Collaborate within a 5-member technical crew to provide stage and technical support for up to 20 concerts and departmental events per semester.

Denison Wind Ensemble & Orchestra, Granville, Ohio Sep 2025 - Present
Pianist

- Perform as an ensemble pianist in weekly rehearsals and public concerts, ensuring high-quality musical delivery.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Denison International Student Association, Granville, Ohio Upcoming: Sep 2026
Public Relations Chair

Beijing No.35 High School, Beijing, China

Oct 2023 – Sep 2024

Head of Visual Communication Department, International Division

- Led a student visual communications team to design and implement promotional strategies for school events and cultural initiatives, reaching an audience of 1,000+ students and families.
- Created visually compelling posters, brochures, and digital media for concerts, open days, and community outreach projects, increasing event participation by ~20%.
- Managed and mentored a design team of 4 peers, ensuring visual consistency across print and digital platforms.

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent) | Technical: Microsoft Office, Python (Basic) , Java (Basic) | Music Performance | Event Organization